in the media, an internal investigation did not reveal anything about him or the person who might have been his handler.'

Intelligence agencies are now facing increasing pressure from various social groups who demand accountability for their functions. In 2012, the Centre for Public Interest Litigation filed a writ petition in the Supreme Court seeking a proper mechanism, following the models of other democratic countries, to ensure the accountability of the government's three intelligence agencies, namely IB, R&AW and the National Technical Research Organisation (NTRO). The petition argued that the intelligence agencies are public authorities that have operated since their inception under executive orders issued by the government without accountability to the Indian Parliament or any other democratic institution. The petition also noted that India has the dubious distinction of being the only democracy in the world whose intelligence agencies have no legitimacy in the eyes of the law and are not accountable to the people or the Parliament. Further arguments highlighted that in the USA, two Congressional committees were set up in 1976 and 1977 to document the systematic abuse of power by the US intelligence agencies within the country and abroad. This led to the establishment of oversight mechanisms in the USA. Other countries, such as the UK, Australia, Canada and South Africa followed suit. In the UK, the Security Service (SS) known as MI5, responsible for domestic espionage, and the Security Intelligence Service (SIS), called MI 6, responsible for external intelligence, are governed by the Security Services Act 1989 and the Intelligence Services Act 1994, respectively. The Canadian intelligence, known as Canadian Security Intelligence Service (CSIS), is governed by the Canadian Security Intelligence Service Act 1984, while the Intelligence Services Act 2001 (ISA) governs the Australian intelligence organisation. In Germany,